

ken? It is the Business of the Government to manage Matters relating to the Government; it is the Business of Subjects to mind only their own Properties and Interest: If my Interest is not shaken, what have I to do with Matters of Government? They are not within my Sphere: If the Government does come to shake my particular Interest, the Law is open for me, and I may redress myself by Law: And when I intrude myself into other Mens Business, that does not concern my particular Interest, I am a Libeller.

These I have laid down for plain Propositions; now then let us consider further, whether, if I will take upon me to contradict the Government, any specious Pretence that I shall put upon it shall dress it up into another Form, and give it a better Denomination; and truly I think it will not, I think 'tis the worse, because it comes in a better Dress; for by that Rule, every Man that can put on a good Vizard, may be as Mischievous as he will to the Government at the bottom: So that whether it be in the form of a Supplication, or an Address, or a Petition, if it be what it ought not to be, let us call it by its true Name, and give it its true Denomination, It is a Libel.

Then, Gentlemen, consider what this Petition is: This is a Petition relating to something that was done and ordered by the Government. Whether the Reasons of the Petition be true or false, I will not examine that now, nor will I examine the Prerogative of the Crown, but only take Notice that this relates
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